



Contact

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Education

2005

LLM - International Human Rights
Wits University (dissertation not submitted)

1998

Masters - Democratic Governance
University of Cape Town (dissertation not submitted)

1996

Bachelor - Social Science & Law
University of Cape Town

Expertise

- Gender Transformation
- Gender-based Violence
- Inclusion, Diversity, Equity & Belonging
- Monitoring & Evaluation
- Training & Facilitation
- Research & Report-writing
- Programme Development & Management
- Rapporteurship
- Public Speaking
- Lobbying & Advocacy
- Media Engagement

Rikky Minyuku

Gender Specialist, Facilitator, Speaker

25 years of working in development, human rights and social justice in Africa has enabled me to develop a systems-thinking lens and broad perspective on gender equality. Working with a wide range of organisations and formations has honed my skills as a facilitator, researcher, writer and programme developer. Leadership roles and running my own consultancy have strengthened organisational skills, fundraising and financial management; while working with people from all walks of life has sharpened my feminist leadership practices. All combine to support or lead organisations through change.

Experience

2020 - current

+9Futures, Johannesburg South Africa

Director

As director, I have led the organisation in developing and implementing a diversity management programme pilot for public school leadership in Gauteng, South Africa. The programme developed a community of practice amongst school leadership and trained participants on implementing leadership practice incorporating diversity and inclusion, as well as understanding systems thinking in implementing change at their schools. The programme included a research element to measure impact over the year of implementation. It was conducted in partnership with Social Surveys Africa, The Gauteng Department of Education and the Matthew Goniwe Leadership Institute.

2018 - current

Womaniko Transforming Spaces, Johannesburg South Africa

Director

As director, I play a management role for staff and drive gender transformative practices within the organisation, and with our partners and clients. I also lead programmes on sexual harassment, gender transformation, gender-based violence and evaluations with clients in the corporate, non-profit and philanthropy sector. I also source clients through relationship building and the development of proposals including budget development. As programme lead I drive implementation and monitor budgets. Report-writing is an essential aspect of my work, requiring desk-top, qualitative and quantitative research. Facilitation, public speaking and media engagement fall within my remit; as a result I speak on behalf of the organisation in all media and social media spaces, as well as write or edit opinion pieces. Our work is driven by research on developments in relation to gender equality and consistent engagement with other experts and advocates on a range of national and international platforms.

2018 - current

Cohesion Collective, Johannesburg South Africa

Senior Associate

As a senior associate, I lead programme development and facilitation with clients in the corporate, social enterprise, non-profit and education sector focused on diversity, inclusion, equity and belonging globally. I play a key role in practical training for new facilitators on the programme content and improving facilitation skills. I also provide gender expertise for the organisation, leading all projects related to sexual harassment and gender transformation.

2016 - 2018

Emuthini Consulting, Johannesburg South Africa

Associate

As an associate, I facilitated training for corporate clients on diversity and inclusion. I also contributed to report-writing and the development of training materials for clients.

Corporate Clients

- SASOL (South Africa)
- ABSA CIB (South Africa)
- ABInBev (South Africa)
- Motus (South Africa)
- Hogan Lovells (South Africa)
- 2U (global)
- BASF (South Africa)
- VWSA
- YellowSeed
- Standard Bank
- Roche Diagnostics (South Africa)
- Accenture Song (global)
- SAGE (South Africa)
- Elinjical Solutions (South Africa)
- PPS (South Africa)
- First National Bank (South Africa)
- Glencore (South Africa)
- Woolworths (South Africa)
- OpenText (global)
- Korumo & GIZ
- Deep Wellness
- TalentTalks
- Social Surveys Africa
- Reckitt
- Retrolex
- Run to the Monster

Experience

2009 - 2016

Independent Consultant

As an independent consultant I provided a range of services for non-profit, philanthropic, state and multilateral institutions including facilitation, research, rapporteuring and project management. During this period my work was largely focused on human rights, constitutional development and social development. I worked extensively in the Southern African region and continent, spending time in Addis Ababa and Juba. Report-writing and editing were a core part of the role I played for clients at this time.

2007 - 2009

Human Rights Watch, Johannesburg South Africa

Country Director

As country director, I was responsible for staff management, fundraising, programme development, research, advocacy and media engagement. I was also responsible for governance, working with the advisory board and global leadership team. As part of a global organisation, I worked with teams in different regions and across different human rights areas. During my tenure the country office was established; advocacy was conducted on women's rights, LGBTQI rights, socio-economic rights, xenophobia, and the Responsibility to Protect doctrine. The office also contributed to the annual human rights report and acted as a hub for human rights researchers and advocates in the southern African region, particularly Zimbabwe and Angola.

2004-2007

Mhudi, Centurion South Africa

Director

As director of this small consultancy I provided a range of services for non-profit, philanthropic, state and multilateral institutions including facilitation, research, rapporteuring and project management. During this period, I provided scoping and research services for the Sigrid Rausing Trust to identify and partner with grantees in South Africa. I also worked with Keystone, a global network of development practitioners in developing the Theory of Change Model and the Community Voice model and implementing it with impact focused networks and non-profit organisations in South Africa.

2002-2004

National Paralegal Institute, Johannesburg South Africa

National Training Coordinator

As National Training Coordinator, I was responsible for the registration of an accredited national qualification for community-based paralegals. I also developed and coordinated training throughout the country for this population who were providing legal services at community level without formal training or recognition. A key part of my work was advocating for recognition of this crucial service at community-level and for it to be funded.

2001

South African Human Rights Commission, Johannesburg South Africa

Constitutional Legislation Officer

As the constitutional legislation officer, I assisted the South African Human Rights Commission to develop the systems to fulfil its obligations in terms of constitutional legislation related to the Promotion of Equality and Prevention of Unfair Discrimination Act and the Access to Information Act. This entailed training commissioners and staff on their obligations and developing systems to monitor other institutions, receive complaints and receive required reports. I also led the initial research team housed in the Department on Justice and Constitutional Development that established how to implement regulations on hate speech and hate crimes. Finally, I provided training for other state institutions and the judiciary on obligations in terms of this legislation.

Non-Profit Clients

- Harambee
- Sexual Violence Research Institute
- Buhle Farming Academy
- Trust for Community Outreach & Education
- Gala Queer Archive
- SisterLove Inc
- Tekano
- Southern African Rural Women's Assembly
- Oxfam South Africa
- Oxfam GB Southern Africa
- SADC Council of NGOs
- Afrika Ikalafe
- SheDecides
- Seriti Institute
- Shukumisa
- ACT Ubumbano
- Economic Justice Network
- SocioNext
- Positive Women's Network
- Nkuzi Development Association
- Turning Tides
- Lerato la Basadi
- Initiative for Strategic Litigation in Africa
- Lerato la Basadi
- Turning Tides
- LifePath (USA)
- Nelson Mandela Children's Foundation
- WeDARE Network
- Zanele Mbeki Trust (AFWID)

Experience

1999 - 2000

National Association of Democratic Lawyers, Cape Town South Africa

Parliamentary Lobbyist and Researcher

As parliamentary lobbyist I played a key role in the foundation of the Equality Alliance, an alliance of non-profit organisations, trade unions and think tanks, that advocated through parliament for the widest possible application of the equality clause in developing the Promotion of Equality and Prevention of Unfair Discrimination Act. As a result, I represented civil society in the drafting process ensuring that discrimination based on socio-economic status, LGBTQI status and HIV status were included. Further, I drafted the section on the act related to the responsibility to promote equality. I lobbied at parliament on the final report for the Truth and Reconciliation Commission, as well as the the Access to Information Act. This role entailed engaging with the media, stakeholder management, community education, written submissions and direct engagement with political parties, parliamentarians and business leaders. The core research focus in this role was on improving the role and function of the constitutional bodies including the South African Human Rights Commission, the Public Protector and the Commission for Gender Equality.

Writing

Report-writing is a critical part of my work which has allowed me to develop strong research skills and content development skills. As these reports are for clients they are not published and are often not publicly available. However I have also written for media articles for publication. My facilitation work has seen me develop training and facilitation materials. Below is a limited list of reports, articles and materials that I have developed.

- **Church Land Programme Partnership Assessment Report**
For client: Afrikagrupperna
December 2023
- **Female Student Network Trust Partnership Dialogue Report**
For client: Afrikagrupperna
December 2023
- **SVRI Leadership Council and Board Annual Meeting Report**
For client: Sexual Violence Research Initiative
November 2023
- **Doing Gender Transformative Business in Africa Facilitator Training Materials**
For client: Korumo and GIZ
November 2023
- **Accenture Song Leadership Immersion Course Feedback Report**
For client: Accenture Song
October 2023
- **Buhle Farming Academy Diversity, Inclusion and SH Training Feedback Report**
For client: Buhle Farming Academy
September 2023
- **Buhle Farming Academy Diversity, Inclusion and Sexual Harassment Toolkit**
For client: Buhle Farming Academy
September 2023
- **TCOE Strategic Planning Report and Theory of Change**
For client: Trust for Community Outreach and Education
June 2023
- **Shift the Needle Programme Feedback Report**
For client: Woolworths
April 2023

Philanthropy Clients

- Foundation for Human Rights
- Sigrid Rausing Trust
- EED Small Grants Fund
- Afrikagrupperna
- Kagiso Trust
- Southern Africa Trust
- Global Giving

State/Multi-lateral Clients

- Commission for Gender Equality
- Department of Justice and Constitutional Development
- Department of Sports and Culture
- Gauteng Department of Education
- Matthew Goniwe Leadership Institute
- South African Parliament
- International IDEA
- TennisSA
- Development Bank of Southern Africa
- World Food Programme
- Department of International Relations and Cooperation
- Africa Union Commission Department of Political Affairs

- **Diversity Management Support Programme Training Materials, Reports & Online Handbook**
For client: Matthew Goniwe Institute of Leadership, Social Surveys Africa and Gauteng Department of Education
April 2023
- **Addressing Working Mother's Needs in the World of Work**
TalentTalks Online Article
February 2023
- **Sexual Harassment Training Materials**
For client: Elinjical Solutions & Cohesion Collective
August 2022
- **Gender Mainstreaming Conversation Materials**
For client: Development Bank of South Africa & Cohesion Collective
August 2022
- **Youth Online Dialogue Report**
For client: Kagiso Trust
April 2022
- **GESI in Plumbing Industry Training Materials and Facilitator Handbook**
For client: Harambee & Cohesion Collective
January 2022
- **Multi-Stakeholder Regional Dialogue Report**
For client: Southern Africa Trust
November 2021
- **Community Perceptions on Digital Access to Address GBV**
For client: Gordon Institute of Business Science & WeDARE Network
July 2021
- **SheDecides Movement Building Workshop Report**
For client: SheDecides South Africa
April 2021
- **Southern African Rural Women's Assembly 10 Year Evaluation Report**
Co-authored for client: Trust for Community Outreach and Education
February 2021
- **Lerato la Basadi Annual Report**
For client: Lerato la Basadi
December 2020
- **Gender & Economic Justice: Realising a Gendered Approach to Rebuilding the Economy**
For client: Economic Justice Network
November 2020
- **Training Materials and Political Manifesto Gage for Children**
For client: Nelson Mandela Children's Foundation & Afrika Ikalafe
March 2019
- Transformation Policy & Practice Review and Benchmark
For client: Hogan Lovells & Cohesion Collective
October 2018
- **Fear is a daily reality for South African women - let's change that**
Opinion Piece published with Daily Maverick
August 2017
- **Regional Nutrition and HIV Workshop Materials**
For client: World Food Programme
September 2015

Academic Clients

- University of South Africa (MDEA)
- University of Witwatersrand (Gender Equity Office)
- University of Cape Town (AFEMS)
- Kingsmead College
- St. Benedicts Boys School
- Cornwall Hill High School
- Cornwall Hill Pre-primary
- St. David's Boys School
- Westville Boys School

Languages

English	Fluent
Sesotho	Conversational
Afrikaans	Conversational
French	Conversational

- **Summary Overview & Conclusions: Brainstorm workshop on expanding the AU doctrine on unconstitutional changes of government and to engage stakeholders in promoting and implementing the African Charter on Democracy Elections and Governance**
For client: Africa Union Commission Department of Political Affairs & International IDEA
July 2014
- **Support for Constitution-Building in South Sudan Workshop Report - "Constitutional Designs for Political Power and Wealth Sharing: Experiences from Africa"**
For client: Department of International Relations and Cooperation & International IDEA
November 2013
- **RSDP, MDG and RPO Workshop Report**
For client: SADC Council of NGOs
March 2013
- **Conference Report: Expert Conference on Constitutionalism and Shared Values**
For client: UNISA Institute for African Renaissance, AU Commission Department of Political Affairs and International IDEA
January 2011
- **Addis Ababa Statement**
For client: UNISA Institute for African Renaissance, AU Commission Department of Political Affairs and International IDEA
December 2010
- **Letter to Deputy Minister of Foreign Affairs of South Africa**
Human Rights Watch
February 2008
- **Letter to South Africa on the Refugee Amendment Bill**
Human Rights Watch
August 2008
- **Together Schools Workshop Report**
For client: Shanduka & Keystone Associates
December 2006
- **Beneficiary Stories for 16 Days of Activism Programme 2003-2004**
co-authored For client: Foundation for Human Rights
April 2006
- **Report on Good Practice in Corporate Social Responsibility in Africa**
For client: Japan Bank of International Development, UNISA Centre for Corporate Citizenship & AccountAbility
February 2006
- **Enhancing Performance for project partners in South Africa**
co-authored For client: GlobalGiving
January 2006
- **World Cup 2010 "An African World Cup" Workshop Report**
For client: Department of Sports and Culture
August 2005

References

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